

1 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

How might Teddy feel?

What we are practising

Name possible feelings and consider a kind response.

What you need

No materials; a soft toy is optional

Tell the story about an imaginary animal.

Before you begin

Choose a calm moment; children may pass on any question.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Say: "Teddy built a tower and it fell."
2. Ask how Teddy might feel and accept more than one idea.
3. Try a kind response, such as "Would you like help rebuilding?"

Talk, draw or show your idea

How could we find out what Teddy needs?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The friendly pretend shop

What we are practising

Take conversational turns and make a clear request.

What you need

Three large safe household objects

Draw goods on paper and point to them.

Before you begin

Set out a towel, cup and toy as shop goods; no money is needed.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Model a request: "May I have the cup, please?"
2. Let the shopkeeper hand over the named object and reply.
3. Swap roles, then try asking for an object that is not available.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could the shopkeeper say if there are no cups left?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Fold a little towel

What we are practising

Follow an ordered practical task and check the result.

What you need

Two small clean towels

Use two cloth napkins.

Before you begin

Place a towel flat in front of each person.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Smooth your towel and invite the child to copy.
2. Bring one short edge to the opposite edge and press the fold.
3. Fold once more if manageable, then carry the towels to their shelf together.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could we adjust if one edge sticks out?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A home for every toy

What we are practising

Use categories and shared roles to complete a household task.

What you need

Two open baskets / Six large toys of two types

Use two clear areas on a low shelf instead of baskets.

Before you begin

Choose a small area; agree that cars go here and soft toys there.

Use light open containers on the floor; an adult handles heavy objects and lids.

Try it together

1. Place one example toy in each basket.
2. Take turns choosing a toy and saying where it belongs.
3. Check the area together and celebrate the shared job without racing.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How will we remember where to find the cars tomorrow?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Our turn-taking tower

What we are practising

Practise shared turns and agree how to restart after a fall.

What you need

Six large lightweight blocks

Use broad lightweight empty boxes.

Before you begin

Sit on the floor with the blocks between you.

Build on the floor using lightweight blocks and keep the tower below the child's shoulder.

Try it together

1. Agree "one block each turn" and place the first block.
2. Take turns adding blocks while naming whose turn comes next.
3. If it falls, pause and agree whether to rebuild or make a wider base.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can we make room for both our ideas?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. How might Teddy feel?

A little hint

Suggest asking rather than assuming: help, a pause, or trying alone?

Answer / what to notice

Teddy might feel sad, annoyed or ready to try again; asking what helps is a useful response.

The same event can bring different feelings, so faces alone do not tell us everything.

Make it easier

Offer two feeling words and allow pointing.

Take it further

Invent two different helpful responses.

Another day, away from the screen

Use “Would you like help?” during ordinary play.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. The friendly pretend shop

A little hint

Offer “We do not have that; would you like this instead?”

Answer / what to notice

A clear spoken request, gesture or point is welcome; replies should match what is available.

Waiting for the other person’s reply makes the exchange easier to follow.

Make it easier

Offer only two goods and model both roles.

Take it further

Ask for two goods in one request.

Another day, away from the screen

Practise a clear request during a family snack.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Fold a little towel

A little hint

Line up the corners before pressing the fold.

Answer / what to notice

A usable fold is enough; edges do not need to be perfectly matched.

Breaking a job into a few visible actions helps a child join in.

Make it easier

An adult holds one edge while the child brings the other across.

Take it further

Explain the steps to a toy before folding another towel.

Another day, away from the screen

Choose one small folding job after laundry.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. A home for every toy

A little hint

Leave an example visible or draw a simple picture label.

Answer / what to notice

Any agreed, reachable storage arrangement works if everyone can find and return the toys.

A consistent home for objects supports finding them again.

Make it easier

Tidy only three toys into one basket.

Take it further

Let the child propose and explain the two categories.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw a picture label for each basket.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Our turn-taking tower

A little hint

Try choosing the next block together before placing it.

Answer / what to notice

A shared construction with fair turns meets the task; its height is not the goal.

A predictable turn rule helps both builders contribute.

Make it easier

Pass each block directly to the next builder.

Take it further

Agree on two sections to build separately and connect.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the same turn rule when adding to a shared drawing.